Wanshu Zhang

Belval, Luxembourg | wanshu.zhang@uni.lu

Latest research and projects: wanshu-personal-site.vercel.app | GitHub

Digital historian combining historical source criticism, linguistics and LLM evaluation. My PhD develops computational approaches to rumour and examines how earlier reporting failures enter later evidence assessment.

EDUCATION

University of Luxembourg, C²DH Jul 2023–present

PhD researcher in History / Digital History. Expected defence: June 2027.

Doctoral research: computational definitions of rumour and rumour-induced epistemic contamination.

Higher School of Economics, Moscow Sep 2020–Jun 2022

M.A. in Linguistic Theory and Language Description.

Henan Institute of Science and Technology Sep 2014–Jun 2018

B.A. in Biological Engineering.

PUBLICATIONS

Zhang, W. (2026). Validating Rule-Based Classification of Historical Fake News with Event Extraction: A Case Study of the Great Moon Hoax of 1835. CLNLP 2025, revised selected papers, pp. 39–46. Springer. DOI

Zhang, W. (2026). LLM-Based Frame and Stance Annotation for 19th-Century Rumour Discourse in US and UK Newspapers. Proceedings of NeoLLM 2026. DOI

ACCEPTED / FORTHCOMING PAPERS

Zhang, W. (forthcoming). The Editor's Dilemma: A Browser-Based Serious Game Prototype for Teaching Epistemic Vocabulary Through Historical Misinformation. JCSG 2026, LNCS 17233. DOI

Zhang, W. (forthcoming). RecycloLux: A Multilingual Serious Game Demo for Civic Waste Sorting Literacy in Luxembourg. JCSG 2026, LNCS 17233. DOI

Author proofs completed; online publication expected late November 2026 (2027 proceedings year).

SELECTED CONFERENCE CONTRIBUTIONS

Zhang, W. (2026). PRESTO: A Two-Phase Methodology for Discovering and Tracking Rumoured Events in Historical Newspapers. DH2026; conference abstract and presentation. Abstract

Zhang, W. (2026). Linking Rumour Flows: A Gazetteer-Based Toolkit for Source and Reuse Detection in Historical Newspapers. EADH 2026; poster abstract. DOI

Zhang, W., Liao, M., & Wang, Y. (2026). The Anatomy of Digital Haunting: Extracting the Universal Mechanism of Fear from a Case Study of Northeast China's Dreamcore. Spatial Humanities 26; abstract and presentation.

MANUSCRIPTS

Family Resemblance across Analytical Layers: Rumour, Hoax, Misinformation, Satire, Parody, and Propaganda in Nineteenth-Century Newspapers. Submitted to Digital Humanities Quarterly.

From Rules to LLMs: A Same-Sample Evaluation of Rumour Extraction from Nineteenth-Century British and American Newspapers. Extended journal article in preparation.

SELECTED RESEARCH AND DIGITAL PROJECTS

EpiTrace — completed pilot evaluation 2026 Code

Designed and implemented a benchmark of repetition, source dependence and uncertainty: 39 fictional scenarios, 234 document packets and 468 Apertus 8B/70B responses. Released reproducible evaluation materials; submitted to Hack Apertus 2026.

PRESTO and RumourFlow — doctoral research software

Developed PRESTO for event discovery and tracking; its extraction study targets explicit rumour/rumor vocabulary. Built RumourFlow to inspect attribution and reuse through source cues, gazetteers, clustering and graph-ready exports.

RumourFlow code

Rumour-induced epistemic contamination — doctoral research, ongoing

Restored Livingstone source material and developed a coding framework. Examines how newspapers invoke earlier false or disputed death reports when assessing later reports, and whether these references accompany demands for additional corroboration.

Eugène Ruppert Sino-Luxembourg digital heritage initiative 2026–ongoing

Project lead; secured external non-academic financial support. Developing a public-facing archival and storytelling initiative connecting Luxembourg and China. Proposal accepted by the 2026 International Conference on Global Cultural and Creative Industries and Development.

Interactive public and educational systems 2026

Designed and deployed RecycloLux, a multilingual civic-learning game. Built From Corpus to Classroom, a teacher-controlled historical evidence-deck generator; HKADH 2027 workshop proposal accepted. RecycloLux

Helsinki Digital Humanities Hackathon — #Books May 2026

Co-built a manually annotated 1,200-record VD16/VD17 dataset with a domain expert; compared LLM prompting strategies and developed a 3D visualisation of semantic change.

SELECTED ADVANCED TRAINING

European Summer University in Digital Humanities, Besançon Jul–Aug 2025

Humanities Data and Mapping Environments — two-week workshop, 21 July–2 August. Université Marie et Louis Pasteur; instructors David Wrisley and Voica Puşcaşiu.

Co-developed and presented a group mapping project on interpretations of natural patterns in building stones among participants from different cultural backgrounds. Training included humanities-data curation and open-source GIS. Workshop

DHSI, Montréal (June 2026): Linked Open Data and the Semantic Web; AVAnnotate digital exhibits. Erasmus+ programme, Silesian University of Technology (May–July 2026): knowledge representation, logic and reasoning.

HONOURS AND TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Best Oral Presentation, CLNLP 2025; Full Scholarship, Higher School of Economics (2020); Chinese National Inspirational Scholarship (2016).

Methods: NLP, LLM evaluation, annotation design, manual validation, error analysis, source criticism and data visualisation. Tools: Python, R, spaCy, Stanza, CoreNLP, SentenceTransformers, DuckDB; ULHPC/SLURM, Docker, GitHub Actions, pytest; HTML/CSS/JavaScript. Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent).